So I just have made a couple points there you might want to comment.

And one last thing, General, I understand the Afghan army is still under 50,000 men. How could we ever expect the Afghan army—in Iraq we have built up a major force and it seems to me— how can you rely on an army of under 50,000 men with a country the size of Afghanistan? Why do we not rely on what is natural to them and that is their militias and their—what would be the equivalent of their National Guard?A whole different strategy. Just some thoughts.

General Jones. The traditional function of an army is to defend the integrity of the country. I think the number is 80,000. But whatever it is there it is encouraging at any rate to see the people of Afghanistan, at least during the time I was there, react to the national army. But again I think you can create the size, you can continue to create the size of the army that one wants. And here there is a similarity between Iraq as well. If you do not create the internal security mechanisms that are required to sustain and overcome the problems that face the individual citizen every day then you are losing ground because armies generally do not do police work very well, and police do not do army work very well. You need both.

Mr. Rohrabacher. The idea of a militia it should not be something that we just instinctively reject.

General Jones. Right.

Mr. Rohrabacher. And, in fact, it seems to have worked in many places.

General Jones. Right. Well, one of the things that I thought should be considered in Afghanistan is the idea of compulsory national service. Interesting enough, the Afghan army is a volunteer force. What happens to all those young people who choose not to volunteer simply because the money generated by the narcoeconomy can pay them more to be part-time Taliban than full-time Afghan soldiers? So I think the concept of national security in Afghanistan, the country that has a very, very young population, is something that the government should consider. I proposed it privately many times in my meetings but it still is an all-volunteer force. But I think that Afghanistan needs to have its young people educated in the values of democracy and where the country is going so that when you return to society they can be contributing members.

There are too many competing alternatives economically, there are too many other ways to make money in that country that are preventing it from following a more rapid direction in the ways in which we would like to see it go.

Mr. Rohrabacher. Thank you, that is fine. Thank you very much.

Chairman Berman. All right, gentlemen, thank you very much. It has been a very useful hearing. One certainly understands the connection between these two countries and our policy. And I appreciate your spending a long morning with us.

Thank you very much.

[Whereupon, at 12:43 p.m., the committee was adjourned.]

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